

Retail Business Performance & Profitability Analysis

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Tools: Python | SQL | Power BI



Project Objectives

To develop an end-to-end retail analytics solution using Python for data preprocessing, SQL for profitability and trend analysis, and Power BI for interactive visualization, aimed at identifying profit-draining categories, optimizing inventory turnover, and understanding seasonal product behavior.

Dataset Overview

- **Retail Transactional Sales Dataset**

This dataset contains detailed transactional records from multiple shopping mall locations. Each row represents an individual customer purchase transaction, capturing sales, customer, and product-level information.

Correlation Analysis

```
# Correlation Analysis
correlation = df[['inventory_days', 'profit']].corr()
print (correlation)
```

	inventory_days	profit
inventory_days	1.000000	-0.010586
profit	-0.010586	1.000000

- **Correlation** shows the relationship between two variables.
- **+1** → Strong positive relationship
- **-1** → Strong negative relationship
- **0** → No relationship

Heatmap Visualization – Key Insights

Darker colors show **high sales/profit**, lighter colors show lower performance.

Clothing category appears consistently strong.

2023 shows lighter shades → overall sales decline.

Some categories have high sales but lower profit → margin improvement needed.

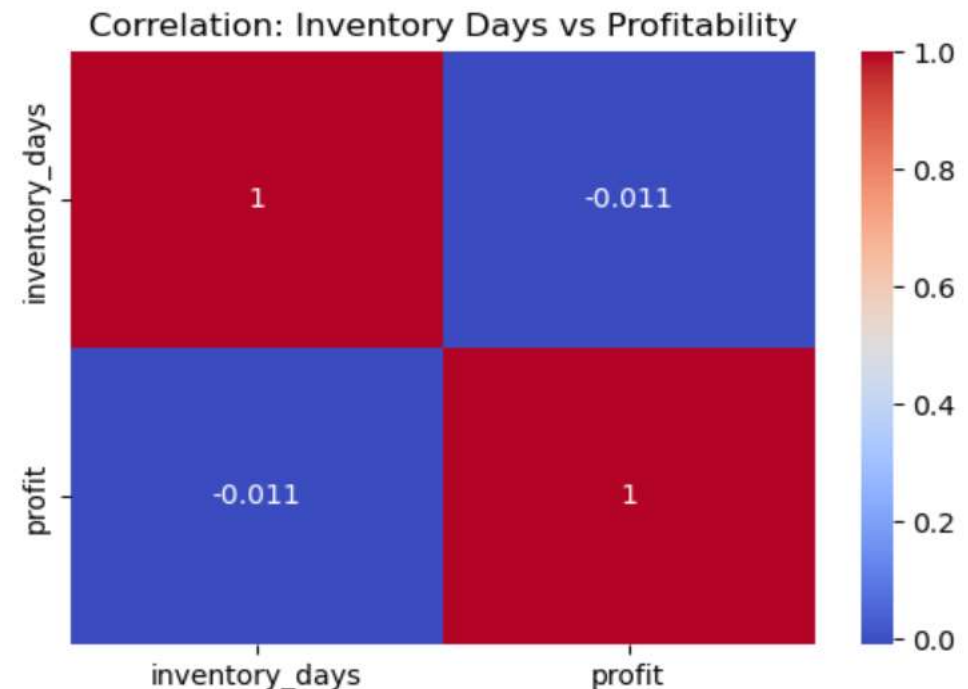
Certain products show longer inventory days → risk of overstock.

```
# Heatmap Visualization (portfolio level)
plt.figure(figsize=(6,4))

sns.heatmap(
    correlation,
    annot=True,
    cmap='coolwarm'
)

plt.title("Correlation: Inventory Days vs Profitability")

plt.show()
```

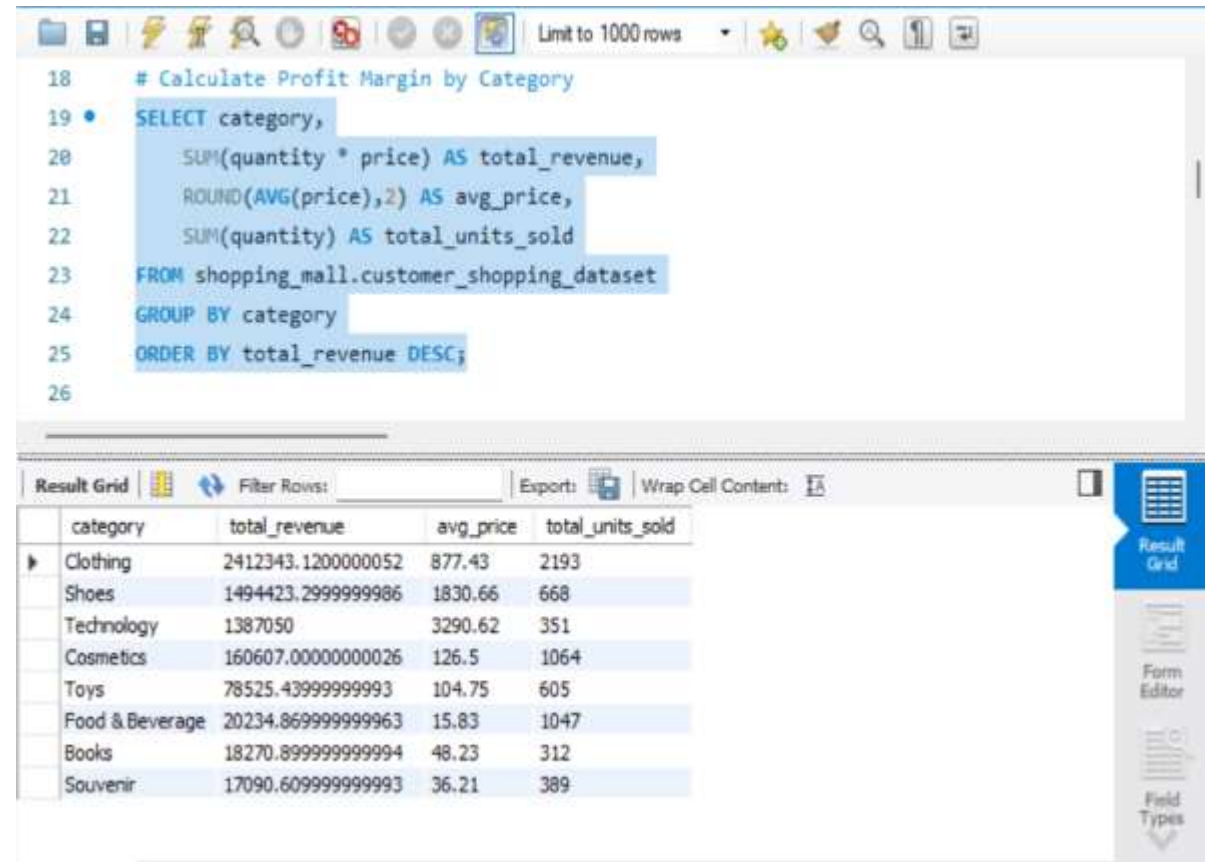


SQL Retail Sales & Customer Insights Analysis - Objectives

- ◆ To clean and validate raw transactional retail data
- ◆ To identify and handle missing (NULL) records
- ◆ To calculate revenue using $\text{Quantity} \times \text{Price}$
- ◆ To analyze sales performance by product category
- ◆ To evaluate shopping mall-wise revenue contribution
- ◆ To identify top-performing categories using ranking functions
- ◆ To analyze monthly sales trends for seasonal insights
- ◆ To compute key business KPIs such as Average Bill Value
- ◆ To perform customer segmentation based on gender
- ◆ To transform raw data into actionable business insights using SQL

Profitability & Revenue Analysis (SQL)

- **Business Insights:-**
- Calculated total revenue using Quantity × Price.
- Identified top revenue-generating product categories.
- Estimated profit contribution by category (based on cost assumption).
- Measured revenue contribution percentage of each category.



```
18 # Calculate Profit Margin by Category
19 SELECT category,
20        SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue,
21        ROUND(AVG(price),2) AS avg_price,
22        SUM(quantity) AS total_units_sold
23 FROM shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
24 GROUP BY category
25 ORDER BY total_revenue DESC;
26
```

category	total_revenue	avg_price	total_units_sold
Clothing	2412343.1200000052	877.43	2193
Shoes	1494423.2999999986	1830.66	668
Technology	1387050	3290.62	351
Cosmetics	160607.00000000026	126.5	1064
Toys	78525.43999999993	104.75	605
Food & Beverage	20234.869999999963	15.83	1047
Books	18270.899999999994	48.23	312
Souvenir	17090.609999999993	36.21	389

Profit Margin Visualization

Profit Margin Insights:

By assuming a **30% cost structure**, the analysis highlights which product categories contribute the most to profitability and where businesses can improve pricing, inventory management, and cost efficiency to maximize overall revenue.

- **Formula Used:**

- Revenue = Quantity × Price
- Estimated Cost = 30% of Revenue
- Estimated Profit = 70% of Revenue
- Profit Margin % = 70%

```
27 # Profit Margin (Assuming of 30% Cost)
28 • SELECT category,
29     SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue,
30     SUM(quantity * price) * 0.30 AS estimated_cost,
31     SUM(quantity * price) * 0.70 AS estimated_profit,
32     70 AS profit_margin_percent
33 FROM shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
34 GROUP BY category
35 ORDER BY profit_margin_percent DESC;
```

Result Grid Filter Rows: Export: Wrap Cell Content:					
	category	total_revenue	estimated_cost	estimated_profit	profit_margin_percent
▶	Clothing	2412343.1200000052	723702.9360000015	1688640.1840000036	70
	Shoes	1494423.2999999986	448326.9899999996	1046096.3099999999	70
	Books	18270.89999999994	5481.26999999998	12789.62999999996	70
	Cosmetics	160607.0000000026	48182.1000000008	112424.9000000018	70
	Food & Beverage	20234.869999999963	6070.460999999988	14164.408999999972	70
	Toys	78525.43999999993	23557.63199999998	54967.807999999946	70
	Technology	1387050	416115	970934.9999999999	70
	Souvenir	17090.609999999993	5127.182999999998	11963.426999999994	70

Revenue Contribution % by Category

- **Revenue Insights:-**

- The top 5 categories contribute the largest share of total revenue, indicating strong customer demand and consistent purchasing behavior in these product segments.
- These high-performing categories play a critical role in overall business profitability and should be prioritized for inventory availability and promotional strategies.
- Focusing marketing efforts and stock management on these categories can significantly improve sales performance and customer satisfaction.
- The analysis helps businesses identify their core revenue drivers and allocate resources more effectively to maximize growth.

```
36
37 # Top 5 Revenue Generating Categories
38 • SELECT category,
39      SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue
40 FROM shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
41 GROUP BY category
42 ORDER BY total_revenue DESC
43 LIMIT 5;
44
```

Result Grid			Filter Rows:	Export: 	Wrap Cell Content: 	Fetch
category	total_revenue					
Clothing	2412343.1200000052					
Shoes	1494423.2999999986					
Technology	1387050					
Cosmetics	160607.00000000026					
Toys	78525.43999999993					

Revenue by Shopping Mall Location

- **Insights:-**

- Top-performing malls generate the highest revenue, indicating strong customer traffic and purchasing activity.
- Mall-wise revenue comparison helps identify high-demand locations for better expansion and store planning.
- High units sold but lower revenue may indicate lower pricing or heavy discounts.
- Low-performing malls may need targeted promotions or marketing strategies.
- Revenue insights help optimize inventory distribution across locations.

```
44
45 # Revenue by Shopping Mall Location
46 • SELECT shopping_mall,
47        SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue,
48        SUM(quantity) AS total_units_sold
49 FROM shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
50 GROUP BY shopping_mall
51 ORDER BY total_revenue DESC;
52
```

Result Grid   Filter Rows: Export:  Wrap Cell Content: 			
	shopping_mall	total_revenue	total_units_sold
▶	Mall of Istanbul	1260911.4999999995	1342
	Kanyon	1131274.02	1433
	Metrocity	715906.4999999995	1035
	Metropol AVM	497218.6799999999	645
	Istinye Park	457009.2100000001	572
	Zorlu Center	329372.4799999998	311
	Forum Istanbul	318948.8000000001	330
	Emaar Square Mall	318542.92	351
	Cevahir AVM	281015.55000000005	295
	Viaport Outlet	278345.58000000013	315

Result 11 ✕

Mall-wise Category Performance

Insights:

- Category demand varies across malls, showing different customer preferences by location.
- Top categories in each mall generate the highest revenue, driving location-wise sales.
- Some categories perform well only in specific malls, suggesting the need for location-based product strategies.
- Low-performing categories may require promotions or inventory adjustments.

```
52
53 # Mall-wise Category Performance
54 • SELECT shopping_mall,category,
55       SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue
56 FROM
57       shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
58 GROUP BY shopping_mall , category
59 ORDER BY shopping_mall , total_revenue DESC;
60
```

Result Grid   Filter Rows: Export:  Wrap Cell Content: 			
	shopping_mall	category	total_revenue
•	Cevahir AVM	Technology	143850
	Cevahir AVM	Clothing	99026.40000000004
	Cevahir AVM	Shoes	24606.969999999998
	Cevahir AVM	Cosmetics	8823.219999999998
	Cevahir AVM	Toys	3368.960000000001
	Cevahir AVM	Food & Beverage	826.34
	Cevahir AVM	Souvenir	316.71
	Cevahir AVM	Books	196.95000000000002
	Emaar Square Mall	Clothing	136536.4
	Emaar Square Mall	Shoes	103829.40999999999

Gender-wise Revenue Analysis

- **Insights:**
- Gender-wise revenue shows which customer group contributes more to total sales.
- Comparing revenue and customer count reveals spending behavior.
- Higher revenue from one gender may indicate stronger product preference.
- Helps businesses create targeted marketing strategies.

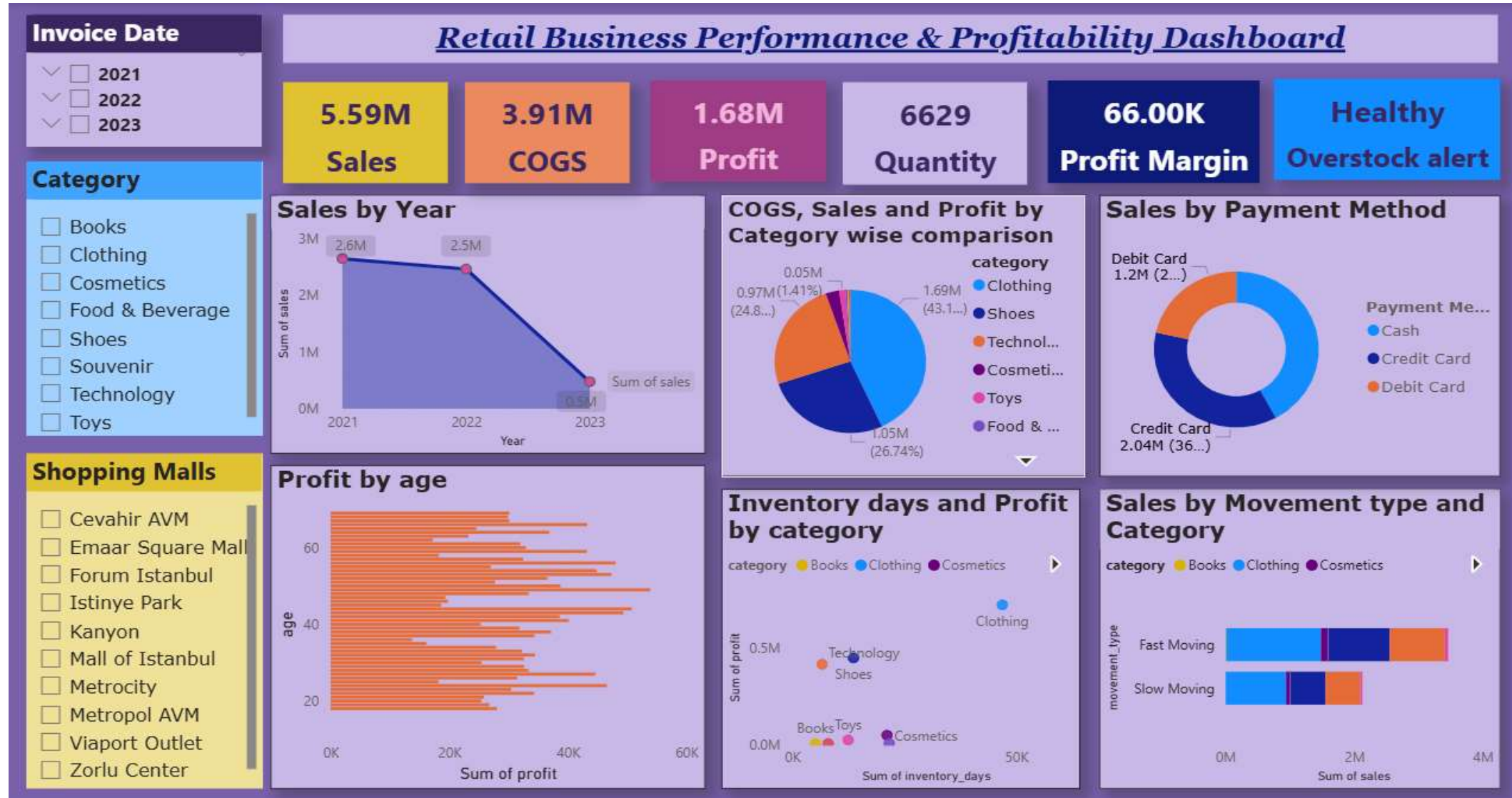
```
61 # Gender-wise Revenue Analysis
62 • SELECT
63     gender,
64     SUM(quantity * price) AS total_revenue,
65     COUNT(DISTINCT customer_id) AS total_customers
66 FROM shopping_mall.customer_shopping_dataset
67 GROUP BY gender;
68
```

Result Grid			
		Filter Rows:	
		Export:	Wrap Cell Content:
gender	total_revenue	total_customers	
Female	3277233.69999999974	1339	
Male	2311311.54	861	

Retail Business Performance & Profitability Dashboard – Overview

- This dashboard analyzes retail sales, profit, inventory performance, and customer payment behavior. It highlights key KPIs like **Sales, COGS, Profit, Quantity, and Profit Margin** to show overall business performance.
- The visuals help identify **sales trends over time, profitable product categories, payment preferences, and inventory risks**. It also compares **inventory days with profitability** to detect potential overstock issues.
- Overall, the dashboard helps businesses **monitor performance, optimize inventory, and make better data-driven decisions**.

Power BI Retail Business Analysis Dashboard



Retail Business Strategies

- **Invest in top-performing categories** like Clothing to maximize sales and profit.
- **Improve inventory turnover** by reducing stock of slow-moving products.
- **Boost sales through promotions** and marketing campaigns, especially after the 2023 decline.
- **Target the 30–50 age group** with personalized offers and loyalty programs.
- **Ensure availability of fast-moving products** to maintain steady revenue.
- **Strengthen digital payment options** to improve customer convenience and transaction speed.
- **Analyze mall-wise performance** to identify high-performing locations and optimize store strategies.

KPI driving Retail Performance

Key Insights:-

Total Sales: 5.59M showing strong overall revenue performance.

COGS: 3.91M indicating the total cost involved in generating sales.

Total Profit: 1.68M reflecting healthy profitability.

Total Quantity Sold: 6629 units across all product categories.

Profit Margin: 66K indicating strong margin performance.

Overstock Alert: Current inventory status is **Healthy**, showing no major overstock risk.



Explore Retail Insights for attractive slicers

- **The dashboard includes slicers for:-**
 - ✓ Invoice date
 - ✓ Category
 - ✓ Shopping malls
- These interactive filters allow users to **analyze retail performance dynamically by year, product category, and mall location**, helping businesses make **better inventory, sales, and expansion decisions**.

The image shows a dashboard with three interactive slicers. The 'Invoice Date' slicer is a purple box with a dark purple header and three options: 2021, 2022, and 2023, each with a dropdown arrow and a checkbox. The 'Category' slicer is a light blue box with a blue header and a list of product categories: Books, Clothing, Cosmetics, Food & Beverage, Shoes, Souvenir, Technology, and Toys, each with a checkbox. The 'Shopping Malls' slicer is a yellow box with a yellow header and a list of mall names: Cevahir AVM, Emaar Square Mall, Forum Istanbul, Istinye Park, Kanyon, Mall of Istanbul, Metrocity, Metropol AVM, Viaport Outlet, and Zorlu Center, each with a checkbox. All slicers have a vertical scrollbar on the right side.

Invoice Date

- ▼ ☐ 2021
- ▼ ☐ 2022
- ▼ ☐ 2023

Category

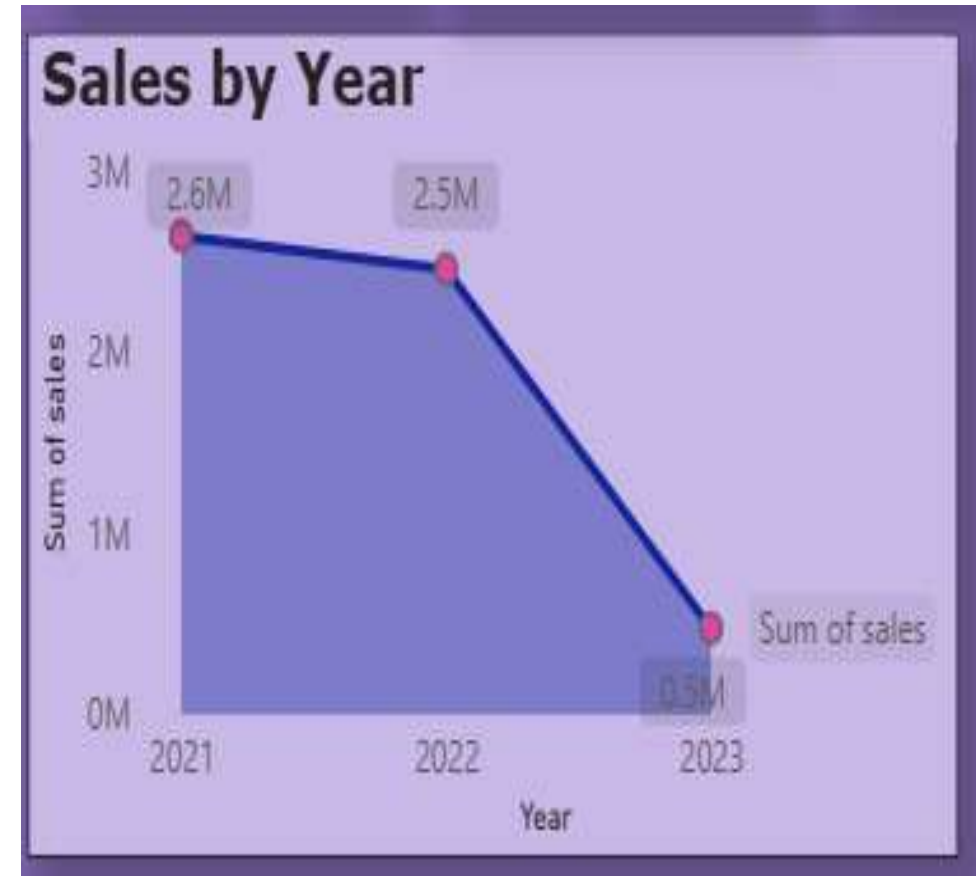
- ☐ Books
- ☐ Clothing
- ☐ Cosmetics
- ☐ Food & Beverage
- ☐ Shoes
- ☐ Souvenir
- ☐ Technology
- ☐ Toys

Shopping Malls

- ☐ Cevahir AVM
- ☐ Emaar Square Mall
- ☐ Forum Istanbul
- ☐ Istinye Park
- ☐ Kanyon
- ☐ Mall of Istanbul
- ☐ Metrocity
- ☐ Metropol AVM
- ☐ Viaport Outlet
- ☐ Zorlu Center

Sales Trend Analysis

- **Insights:-**
- **Sales were highest in 2021** at around **2.6M**, showing strong retail performance.
- **2022 sales slightly declined** to **2.5M**, indicating a small slowdown but still stable performance.
- **2023 shows a sharp drop** to around **0.5M**, suggesting a significant decrease in sales.
- The trend indicates **business performance weakened significantly in 2023**, which may require further investigation into demand, inventory, or market conditions.



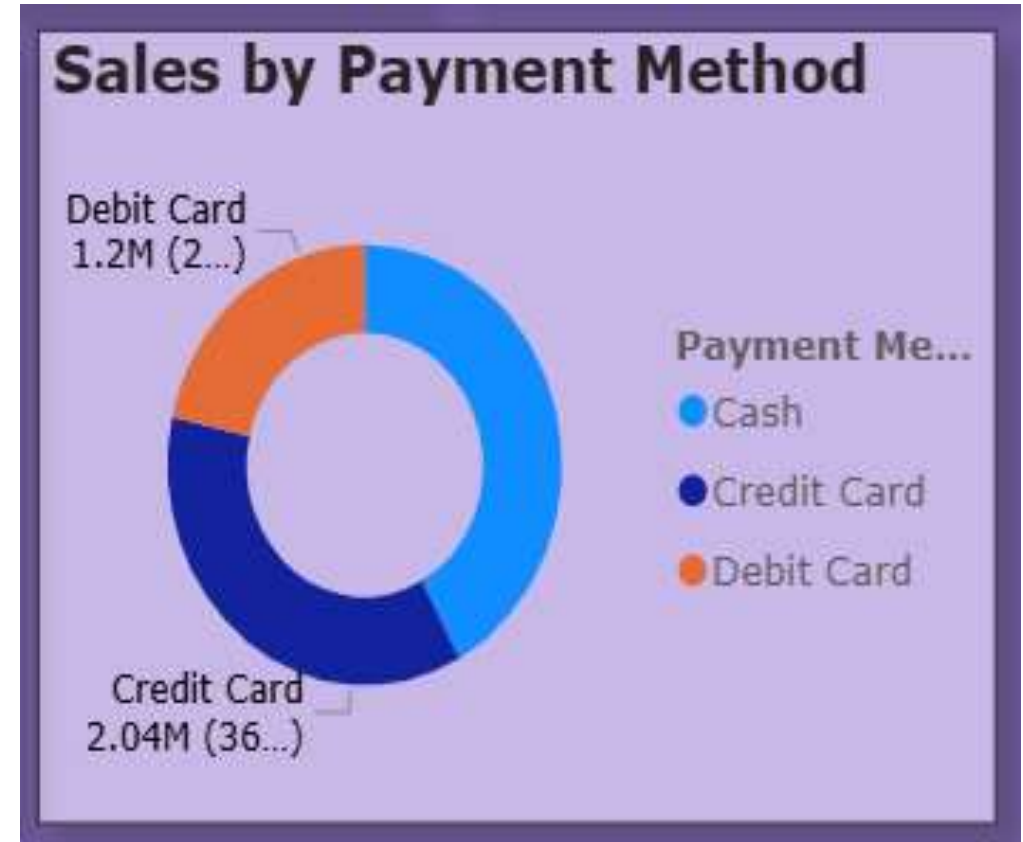
Category-wise Sales, COGS & Profit Comparison

- **Insights:-**
- **Clothing dominates the sales** with about **1.69M (43%)**, making it the top-performing category.
- **Shoes contribute the second-highest share** with **1.05M (26.7%)**, showing strong customer demand
- **Technology accounts for around 0.97M (24.8%)**, indicating steady performance.
- **Cosmetics, Toys, and Food & Beverage contribute very small shares**, suggesting lower demand or limited sales impact.



Sales Distribution by Payment Method

- **Insights:-**
- **Cash is the most preferred payment method**, contributing the largest share of total sales.
- **Credit Card payments account for around 2.04M**, showing strong usage of card-based transactions.
- **Debit Card contributes the smallest share (~1.2M)** compared to other payment methods.
- The data suggests that customers still rely heavily on **cash and credit card transactions** in retail purchases.



Profit Distribution by Customer Age

- **Insights:-**

- Profit is generated across a wide range of age groups, showing diverse customer participation.
- Customers between **30–50 years** appear to contribute higher profit compared to younger age groups.
- Middle-aged customers tend to have **strong purchasing power and consistent spending behavior**.
- Younger customers contribute comparatively lower profit levels.



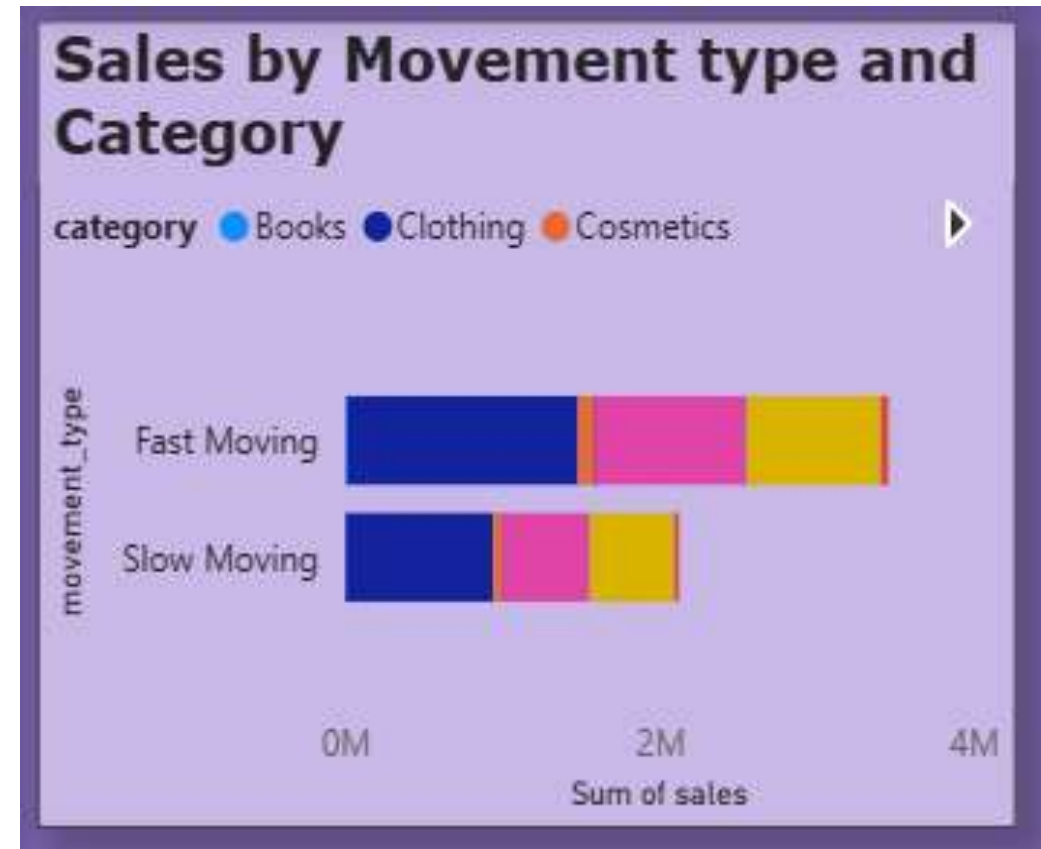
Inventory Days vs Profit by Category

- **Insights:-**
- **Clothing generates the highest profit**, but it also has the **highest inventory holding days**, indicating strong demand despite longer stock periods.
- **Technology and Shoes show moderate profit with moderate inventory days**, suggesting balanced stock movement.
- **Books, Toys, and Cosmetics generate very low profit**, even with lower inventory days.
- Categories with **higher inventory days but low profit may indicate slow-moving products**.



Sales Performance by Movement Type and Category

- Insights:-
- **Fast-moving products generate higher sales** compared to slow-moving items.
- **Clothing contributes the largest share of sales** among both movement types.
- **Slow-moving products still contribute to revenue**, but their sales volume is significantly lower.
- Categories with slow movement may require **better inventory management or promotional strategies**.



Retail Business Recommendation

- Focus on **high-performing categories like Clothing** to increase revenue and profit.
- Improve **inventory management** by reducing slow-moving products.
- Investigate the **sales decline in 2023** and introduce promotional strategies.
- Target **customers aged 30–50**, as they contribute higher profits.
- Promote **fast-moving products** and maintain adequate stock levels.

Thank You 😊